

Westpac McDermott Miller Consumer Confidence, March quarter 2026

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March saw a small 1.8 point drop in the Westpac-McDermott Miller Consumer Confidence index, leaving it at a below average level of 94.7. However, there is increased concern about the outlook for the economy.



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The fog of war.

- Consumer confidence has taken a knock, albeit only a small one at this stage. Our Westpac-McDermott Miller Consumer Confidence index fell 1.8ppts in March, taking it to a level of 94.7 (a level below 100 indicates that there are more households who are pessimistic about economic conditions than those who are optimistic).
- A growing number of households actually told us their financial position had been improving over the past year. However, those improving domestic conditions have now been over taken by more worrying global events.
- Our latest survey was conducted in the first two weeks of March – the same time as the war in the Middle East broke out. Against that backdrop, households have grown a little more nervous about the economic outlook.
- At this stage, the drop in confidence has been relatively limited. However, the war in the Middle East was intensifying over the survey period. As a result, when we spoke to households, many will not have seen the full impact of the conflict or experienced the rise in fuel prices.
- The longer the conflict continues, the larger the resulting disruptions to economic activity and pressure on households' finances will be. That could see confidence dropping back over the coming months.

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